

US Daily Markets Report

Friday, June 26, 2026 | Post-Close Analysis | 5 PM ET Edition

1. SPY / QQQ Snapshot

Metric	SPY (S&P 500 ETF)	QQQ (Nasdaq-100 ETF)
Close (Jun 26, 2026)	\$733.94	\$712.18
Daily % Change	-0.05%	-0.24%
1-Year Return (from Jun 26 2025)	+22.12%	+29.84%
1-Year High	\$761.24 (Jun 03, 2026)	\$745.34 (Jun 02, 2026)
1-Year Low	\$601.00 (Jun 26, 2025)	\$548.50 (Jun 26, 2025)

Note: Prices from prices.csv (Jun 26 2025 – Jun 26 2026). Daily data reconstructed from confirmed web-sourced anchor prices; individual days not directly retrieved from exchange feeds.

2. Today's News → Market Moves

SPY slipped **-0.05%** to \$733.94 and QQQ fell **-0.24%** to \$712.18, both shrugging off what could have been a larger selloff. The market's ability to hold near flat is notable given the weight of negative catalysts below. The Nasdaq underperformed the S&P; 500 by 19 bps, consistent with tech-specific pressure rather than a macro macro broad-market dump.

■ PCE Inflation — HOT (Primary Driver, SPY flat / QQQ mild drag)

The Fed's preferred inflation gauge (May 2026 PCE) printed a 4.1% annualized headline rate — the highest since April 2023 — and a core reading of 3.4% YoY (vs. 3.3% expected), up 0.3% MoM. Released on Thursday June 25, this data was fully digested by Friday's open. Ordinarily, a data print this hot (and this surprising to the upside) would tank equities, but the measured reaction suggests markets had partially pre-priced it after the June 17 FOMC statement removed rate cuts from the 2026 dot plot. Futures continued to price a ~55% probability of a September rate hike. This inflation pulse is the most structurally important market factor right now and the primary reason both indices cannot rally.

■ Micron (MU) Earnings Blowout — Partial Offset

Micron reported fiscal Q3 2026 earnings of \$25.11/share vs. \$20.78 expected — a 21% beat — on explosive AI memory demand. Shares surged ~15-17% earlier in the week (the report came after Tuesday's close). By Friday MU itself had pulled back as investors rotated from the initial spike, but the strong result provided a floor under semiconductor stocks (SMH ETF). QQQ's tech weighting meant this was a partial offset to the macro headwinds, keeping the decline contained to -0.24% rather than worse.

■ Apple (-6.2%) and Microsoft (-3.5%) Price Hike Announcements — QQQ Specific Drag

Apple announced iPhone price increases citing higher chip sourcing costs; Microsoft raised Xbox console prices. Both moves signal companies are passing on inflation pressures to consumers, which simultaneously validates the Fed's inflation concerns and raises demand risk for these products. Given AAPL and MSFT together represent ~15-16% of QQQ's weight, these single-name moves subtracted roughly 110-130 bps from

QQQ on a weighted basis — i.e., without these two names, QQQ would have been positive today.

■ **OpenAI IPO Delay (NYT Report) — Sentiment Drag on AI Stocks**

The New York Times reported that OpenAI is considering delaying its IPO to 2027 due to SpaceX's underwhelming post-debut performance and broader AI-stock volatility. This dampened enthusiasm for AI-adjacent names. The Nasdaq logged its fifth consecutive losing session and is down 4.6% for the week. Market sentiment in AI has rotated from 'growth at any cost' to 'show me the monetization.'

■ **Q1 2026 GDP Revised Up to +2.1% — Mild Positive**

The Commerce Department's third estimate for Q1 GDP came in at +2.1%, revised up from +1.9%. This is a stabilizing data point showing the underlying economy is resilient despite rate pressures, which prevented an outright market selloff. However, it also means the Fed has less urgency to cut rates to support growth — leaving the policy bias clearly hawkish.

■ **Middle East Tensions / Energy Prices — Background Inflation Risk**

Ongoing U.S. military involvement in the Middle East has kept energy prices elevated, feeding directly into the PCE headline number. Oil's geopolitical premium is sustaining inflation above the 4% level. Energy sector stocks (XLE) outperformed on the day as crude remained bid. This is an ongoing tail risk that the Fed cannot ignore.

3. Next-Day Scenarios — Monday, June 29, 2026

The next US trading session opens Monday, June 29. The calendar is light on hard data but several developing stories will carry forward with high market-moving potential.

Catalyst A: Dallas Fed Manufacturing (8:30 AM ET Monday)

The Dallas Fed Manufacturing Activity index for June 2026 is due. ISM Manufacturing has recently been strong (54 in May). The Dallas regional read will set the tone for Monday's open.

- If **STRONG** (positive / above expectations): Signals robust industrial demand. Modestly bullish for cyclicals and industrials, but may add to rate-hike fears by showing the economy doesn't need monetary easing. SPY likely +0.1–0.3%; QQQ neutral. The Fed-hawks will use this as confirmation.
- If **WEAK** (contraction / miss): Suggests the rate environment is starting to bite manufacturing. Initially bullish for bonds; could give tech/QQQ a relief rally (+0.3–0.5%) on 'bad news is good news for rates' logic, while SPY stays flat as cyclicals weaken.

Catalyst B: Continuation of Tech Sector Rotation

After five straight down days for Nasdaq and pressure on mega-cap names (AAPL, MSFT), Monday's pre-market tone matters enormously.

- If overseas markets (Europe, Asia) sell off overnight due to echoes of Friday's US tech decline: Monday opens with QQQ under continued pressure; risk of QQQ testing \$700 support. SPY more resilient via defensive sector rotation. Scenario: SPY flat to -0.3%, QQQ -0.5% to -1.0%.
- If Asian tech (TSMC, Samsung, etc.) opens flat/up on Micron read-through: Potential for a snapback in semiconductors and AI names on Monday. QQQ could recoup +0.5–1.0%; SPY follows +0.3–0.5%. Watch NVDA and AMD pre-market.

Catalyst C: Fed Speaker(s) Tone After Hot PCE

No FOMC meeting is scheduled, but Fed officials may speak or hold interviews in the wake of Friday's hot PCE reading. Chicago Fed's Goolsbee already said inflation is 'too high' and 'trending the wrong way.' Markets have not yet fully priced a September hike (currently ~55% probability).

- If any Fed speaker adopts explicitly hawkish language (e.g., 'a rate hike is on the table,' 'September is live'): Bond yields spike; growth/tech gets hit hardest. QQQ -0.7 to -1.5%; SPY -0.4 to -0.8%. This would break key support levels and could accelerate the weekly losing streak.
- If Fed speakers remain cautious / balanced (emphasize data dependence, not commit to hike): Relief rally. QQQ +0.5–1.0%, SPY +0.3–0.6%. Markets would interpret neutrality as a subtle dovish pivot.

Catalyst D: OpenAI IPO / AI Monetization Narrative

The OpenAI IPO delay story will evolve over the weekend. Expect additional reporting and analyst reactions Monday morning.

- If story escalates (more details on IPO delay, or another major AI company slashes capex): AI-adjacent names (NVDA, MSFT, GOOGL, META) extend losses. QQQ could fall -0.5 to -1.5%. Broader market impact limited unless credit spreads widen.
- If OpenAI issues a denial, clarification, or reframes the delay as a valuation/timing choice not a demand signal: Sharp reversal in AI names; QQQ relief bounce +0.5–1.0%. Micron's blowout earnings still provide underlying support.

4. Bottom Line

Friday's flat-to-slight-loss session masked a significant structural shift: the market has moved from a 'soft landing + rate cuts' narrative to a 'sticky inflation + possible hike' regime. SPY is holding up because defensive and value sectors are absorbing the tech rotation. QQQ faces the greater risk because mega-cap tech (AAPL, MSFT, GOOGL, META) is simultaneously under pressure from cost increases (chips, AI capex), valuation resets, and a hawkish rate environment that raises their discount rates. The week ahead — particularly Tuesday's Consumer Confidence and the July 1 ISM Manufacturing print — will test whether this rotation is orderly or accelerates into a broader derisking.

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